FYP A - Initial Paper Marking Rubric

Your initial paper will be assessed separately by your two markers. If the two evaluations are inconsistent the mark will be moderated by the Chief Examiner.
To pass this assessment, you need to submit your Initial Paper ensuring that it satisfies the pass criteria in the table below.
You must use the template on Moodle.
For the initial paper, the Abstract and Introduction are mandatory, other sections may be included as you and your supervisors deem necessary, you can title these whatever is appropriate for your discipline.

Please also note the following:

- The page limit is 4 pages.
- For group projects, only one paper per group needs to be submitted.
- The appendix and bibliography should be excluded from the template. An acknowledgement of any AI use in the project and in writing the Initial Paper should be included in the Acknowledgements section.

Criterion	Fail	Pass	Credit	Distinction	High Distinction	Mapped ULO
Abstract (mandatory)	Abstract missing, or does not describe the project topic/problem, background, methodology, or results.	A description of the project topic/problem. A short discussion of the background/context for this project. A short description of the methodology and/or methods. Initial and/or anticipated results.	Exceeds all Pass criteria and meets some of the High Distinction criteria.	Exceeds all Pass criteria and meets most of the High Distinction criteria.	A concise, well-written abstract that clearly and confidently describes the project topic/problem, background/context, methodology, and initial/anticipated results, giving the reader an accurate and complete snapshot of the project.	**LO6** Communicate complex engineering research findings to professional and community audiences that adhere to prescribed technical formats and industry standards.
Introduction (mandatory)	Introduction missing, or does not provide any framing, motivation, or context for the project.	Provides an introduction that frames the project and motivates why it matters, though this may be brief or general.	Exceeds all Pass criteria and meets some of the High Distinction criteria.	Exceeds all Pass criteria and meets most of the High Distinction criteria.	A well-structured introduction that clearly and engagingly frames the project, motivates its significance, and leads naturally into the Project Background.	**LO3** Investigate complex engineering problems by identifying salient issues, specifying the problem, and applying evidence-based methods to analyse causes, predict outcomes, and synthesise solution strategies.
Project Background (can be under a section of any name; includes Literature Review, Problem Statement, Aim, and Objectives)	Project Background missing, or does not provide a literature review/state of the field, problem statement, or aims/objectives.	Provides a literature review or state of the field, problem statement, and aims/objectives, though coverage may be basic or the connections between them unclear.	Exceeds all Pass criteria and meets some of the High Distinction criteria.	Exceeds all Pass criteria and meets most of the High Distinction criteria.	Provides a well-integrated Project Background: a relevant literature review or state of the field, a clearly justified problem statement, and clearly defined aims/objectives.	**LO2** Evaluate current and emerging research to critically reflect on knowledge development, future directions, and technological change.
Methodology/Methods or Requirements, Design Specifications & Approach (can be under a section of any name)	Methods, requirements, or design specifications not described, or the proposed approach is inappropriate or unjustified.	Appropriate methods, requirements, design specifications, and/or approach are proposed and justified.	Exceeds all Pass criteria and meets some of the High Distinction criteria.	Exceeds all Pass criteria and meets most of the High Distinction criteria.	Methods, requirements, design specifications and approach are clearly described, well-justified, and demonstrate sound consideration of relevant contextual or risk factors.	**LO5** Apply risk management principles and contextual knowledge, including relevant environmental, social, cultural, economic, legal, or political factors in the design, evaluation, and communication of engineering solutions.

Criterion	Fail	Pass	Credit	Distinction	High Distinction	Mapped ULO
Initial/Anticipated Results and Discussion (can be under a section of any name)	No initial or anticipated results, or discussion of them, presented.	Initial and/or anticipated results are presented, with some discussion.	Exceeds all Pass criteria and meets some of the High Distinction criteria.	Exceeds all Pass criteria and meets most of the High Distinction criteria.	Initial and/or anticipated results are clearly presented and discussed, linked to the proposed methodology, giving a credible and well-substantiated indication of project feasibility.	**LO4** Demonstrate the ability to interpret data, justify assumptions, and develop substantiated conclusions through inquiry, critical evaluation of published information, and experimental evidence or testing.
Conclusion and Future Direction (can be under a section of any name)	No conclusion or future direction provided.	A conclusion and future direction are provided, though these may be brief or generic.	Exceeds all Pass criteria and meets some of the High Distinction criteria.	Exceeds all Pass criteria and meets most of the High Distinction criteria.	A clear conclusion summarising progress to date, with a well-considered and realistic plan for the remaining project timeline.	**LO1** Apply project management and engineering management principles to independently plan, execute, and evaluate a self-directed project.
Consistent and Correct Referencing	Referencing missing, inconsistent, or incorrect; sources not properly cited.	A referencing style is used and is mostly consistent and correct.	Exceeds all Pass criteria and meets some of the High Distinction criteria.	Exceeds all Pass criteria and meets most of the High Distinction criteria.	Referencing is consistent and correct throughout, following a recognised style, with all sources properly cited.	**LO6** Communicate complex engineering research findings to professional and community audiences that adhere to prescribed technical formats and industry standards.
Quality of Presentation (structure, figures and tables, clarity and written expression)	Paper exceeds the page limit, is poorly structured, or is difficult to understand due to unclear writing, or figures/tables are missing or unclear.	The paper is no longer than 4 pages. The academic writing is able to be clearly understood by the marker. The paper has a clear structure which makes it straightforward to read. The tables and figures (if included) are clear, labelled correctly and referenced in the text.	Exceeds all Pass criteria and meets some of the High Distinction criteria.	Exceeds all Pass criteria and meets most of the High Distinction criteria.	The paper is within the page limit, clearly and professionally written, logically structured, with high-quality figures/tables well-integrated into the text.	**LO6** Communicate complex engineering research findings to professional and community audiences that adhere to prescribed technical formats and industry standards.